Console on the Move

How to drive the Console app on an Ableton Move: an 8-track tape with OP-1-style editing, up to 8 instruments (drum machines and synths) and a step sequencer. This covers the controls as they are in November 2026 (updated 4 November). Things still to come are listed at the end.

Starting and stopping

Start Console	Shift + Step 2 (the Move's settings), then choose **RNBO** at the bottom of the list. Console opens by itself after a few seconds. The menu item keeps the name RNBO.
Quit	**Shift + Back**. Saves the song, quits and gives the Move back to its normal software.
If something goes wrong	If the app ever crashes, the Move goes back to normal by itself. What it printed is saved in /data/UserData/console/app.log, and every run keeps a log in /data/UserData/console/crashes (running.log is the current run; a crash adds a crash-.log with the last buttons pressed and where it stopped). Send those when reporting a problem.
Stress test	To hunt for crashes and memory leaks, the app can run by itself for a while: `ssh ableton@move.local "echo 60 > /data/UserData/console/stress"` (60 = minutes). It uses its own projects, so your songs aren't touched. The report is /data/UserData/console/stress-report.txt. Shift + Back stops it early.
Update	On the Move: Menu, SETTINGS, SOFTWARE UPDATE (push to check, push again to install; Console restarts). Or from the Mac: `ssh ableton@move.local "python3 /data/UserData/console/move/move-update.py"`.

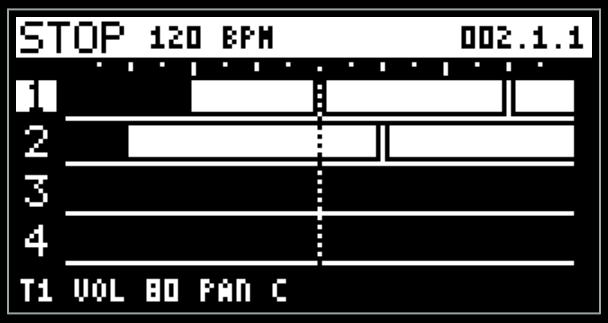
The Move's controls at a glance

Most buttons have a second job with **Shift** held. Each page below says what changes there. The tape's own controls (selecting, arming and muting tracks, track volumes, Copy / Delete / Capture / Sample, moving the playhead) only work on the tape. On the instrument pages, song mode and FX they do nothing, unless that page uses the control for its own job. Play, Record, Loop and Shift + Play (back to the start) work everywhere.

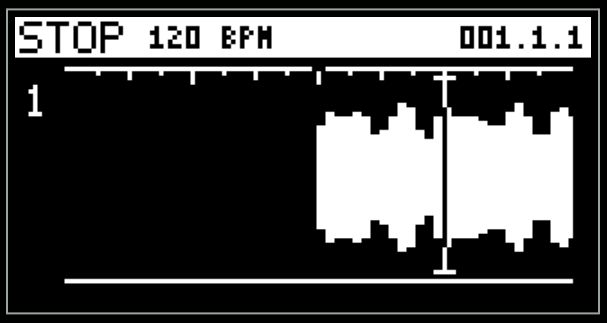
Play	Play / stop. Shift: back to the start (or the loop's start).
Record	Record on the selected track (and any armed tracks). Shift: switch between replacing the tape and adding to it (overdub).
Loop	Loop between the in and out points on / off. Shift: clear the in and out points.
Left / Right arrows	Move the playhead one grid step. Shift: set the loop's in / out point at the playhead.
Undo	Undo the last tape edit (on the drum sequencer: the last pattern edit).
Sample	Splice: split the box under the playhead (at a splice: join it back). Shift: on every track.

Copy (hold)	Copy the box under the playhead. Hold and turn the jog wheel to take more pieces, let go to copy. Shift + Copy: start a selection.
Delete (hold)	Cut, the same way as Copy (it leaves an empty space).
Capture	Drop (paste) what was copied or cut at the playhead. Shift: insert it, pushing the rest of the track later.
Mute	Mute the selected track. Shift: solo it.
Menu	The project menu (songs, tempo, settings). On a sound page: the instrument menu. **Shift + Menu: export.**
Back	Back out of a menu or page. **Shift + Back: save and quit.**
Left buttons (top to bottom)	1 Instruments (press again: the instrument's sound, again: its sequencer, again: back to the instruments; Shift: back one step). 2 Song mode. 3 FX (reverb, delay, song insert 1, song insert 2, then off). 4 The recorder (the tape; press again: the selected track zoomed. Shift: arm all tracks).
Knobs 1-8	Depend on the page (below). On the tape: the 8 tracks' volumes; Shift: pan.
Shift + touch a knob	Pushes that knob (the Pi's knob push): on the tape it mutes that track.
+ / -	The Pi's knob 9: on the tape, zoom in / out. Shift: sweep the in / out points a bar at a time.
Jog wheel	Turn: move the playhead a grid step. Shift + turn: the grid size. Push: back to the start. In lists and menus: turn to pick, push to choose.
Volume knob	Headphone / speaker volume.
Step buttons	On the tape: 1-8 select a track (press the selected one again to zoom in); Shift + step: arm a track. On the drum sequencer: the 16 steps.
Pads	Drums: the left 4 x 4 are the drums (bottom left first; tapping one picks it), the right 4 x 4 play the picked drum chromatically, a semitone a pad (bright pads: the root). A synth plays a scale. **Shift + pad 1-16: the instrument's pattern.**

The tape



The tape page: four tracks at a time (the selected track's group) as solid boxes; a splice is a thin divider. The dotted line is the playhead. Bottom: volume and pan.



Left button 4 again: the selected track zoomed, its sound as a waveform; a splice is an I-beam. The notch in the ruler is the playhead.

Step buttons 1-8	Select a track (its light is white). Selecting doesn't arm it.
Shift + step 1-8	Arm or disarm a track: **armed tracks are red** (selected and armed: red and white blinking) and have a bar beside the number on the screen. **Record only records armed tracks** (arm every track you want: say a drum and a synth together). Armed tracks' instruments sound on the tape page, and Copy / Delete / Sample take them along.
Knobs 1-8	Track volumes. Shift + knob: pan.
Record	Start / stop recording on the selected track and any armed tracks.
Splices	A splice shows as a thin divider between two boxes (zoomed in: an I-beam through the sound).

The zoomed track (left button 4, twice)

Knob 1	Mono / stereo (about 5 clicks to switch).
Knob 2	The input: an instrument's drum, its kit, all kits (and on a stereo track, its left side). About 5 clicks per choice.
Knob 3	A stereo track's right input.
Knobs 4-6	The box under the playhead: gain, fade in, fade out. Shift + touch knob 4: normalize.
Left button 4 / Back	Back to the tape.

Instruments

Left button 1 opens the INSTRUMENTS page: 8 slots, each a drum machine or a synth. Recording an instrument onto the tape uses the zoomed track's input (knob 2).

Jog wheel	Pick a slot. Push: open it (an empty slot: choose what goes in it).
Choosing an instrument	A picture of each instrument scrolls left and right as you turn the wheel (the ones without a picture yet show their name). Push to choose.
SAMPLER	A drum machine of 16 samples, one per drum: each takes a .wav from the Move's sample folders (SAMPLE, LEVEL, PITCH, START, DECAY, PAN, REVERB, DELAY).
Shift + push the jog wheel	On a loaded slot: change it or remove it.
Step buttons 1-8	Mute / unmute a slot.
Left button 1 again	The picked instrument's sound page; again: its sequencer; again: back to this page, and round again. (Shift + left button 1 steps back instead: sequencer or sound, then the instruments, then the tape.)

A synth's settings that are a switch (an oscillator's SAW or PULSE, HOLD...) show **OFF** / **ON** and flip a click at a time. A preset or kit setting turns one preset a click and stops at the last one.

Recording the Move's input jack

The zoomed track's input (knob 2) also offers **INPUT L** and **INPUT R**: whatever is plugged into the Move's audio input (a guitar, a mic). Pick one for a mono track, both for stereo. You hear it while you arm the track.

An instrument's sound

Knobs 1-8	The settings on this page. While one turns, it shows big.
Up / Down (+ / -)	The pads' octave (a synth's pads, and the chromatic drum pads on the right). The screen shows OCT +1 etc.
Left / Right	The previous / next page of settings. On a synth's sound pages the big wheel also turns the pages, one page a click.
Shift + touch a knob	That setting back to its starting value.
Settings that pick a mode	DIST, CHOKE, a wave, on / off: it takes 5 clicks the same way to move to the next choice, so you don't skip past. Shift + turn: one choice a click. Lists get 3 clicks a choice: the lane's RATE, MULTIPLY / PULSE / HOLD / JUMP and the pitch ones, song-mode patterns, the grid and the pattern (Shift + wheel). Numbers (volume, velocity, tune...) take 3 clicks a step.
Knob speed	Shift + turn the volume knob: how many clicks of a knob make one step of a number (1-12, starts at 4). More clicks = easier to be precise. Lists use the speed plus one. It is kept when you switch off.
Reverb and delay	Each drum's REVERB and DELAY knobs on its sound page set how much of that drum goes to the effect. The effects' own settings (size, time, tone, feedback, level) are on left button 3.
Pads	Play the drums (or the synth).
File / Menu	The INSTRUMENT MENU: SAVE PRESET, LOAD PRESET, COPY / PASTE PATTERN, CLEAR PATTERN, CLEAR LOCKS (see Presets below).

Presets (instrument menu)

Press File (or Menu) on an instrument's sound page. Presets are the old "kits": a sound saved for that one instrument (a Dexed patch, a drum kit, a Braids sound) and kept with it.

SAVE PRESET	Name it on the naming screen (below). It is saved for this instrument only.
LOAD PRESET	A list of that instrument's presets: turn the wheel to pick, push to load.
COPY / PASTE PATTERN	Copy the pattern and paste it onto another pattern or another instrument of the same kind.
CLEAR PATTERN / CLEAR LOCKS	Empty the pattern, or only the step settings. Both ask ARE YOU SURE? first.

Naming screen

Used for songs, presets and renaming. The letter you are on is shown inverted, in a white box.

Turn the wheel	Change the letter.
Push the wheel / Shift + push	Move to the next / previous letter.
Delete	Erase the letter.
Play	Save the name. Back: cancel.

LFOs

Every instrument has two LFOs per pattern (a new pattern starts as a copy of the one you came from, then they are separate). On a sound page press **Right** past the last page: LFO 1, again: LFO 2, then INSERT 1 and 2 (see FX).

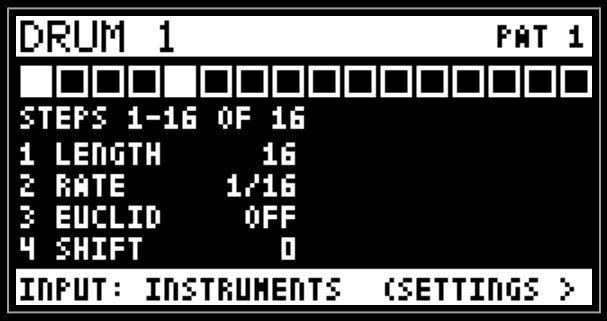
Knob 1 DEST	Which setting it moves (numbers only): the instrument's settings, then the number settings of its two insert effects (shown I1 / I2 and the setting's name, e.g. I1 CUTOFF). Choose the effect first.
Knob 2 WAVE	Sine, triangle, saw up / down, square, random.
Knob 3 SPEED	8 bars down to 1/32 of a beat, in time with the tempo, with triplet speeds (1/2T, 1/4T, 1/8T, 1/16T) after their straight ones.
Knob 4 DEPTH	How far it swings, -100 to +100 %.
Knob 5 PHASE	Where in the cycle it starts.
Knob 6 MODE	FREE (runs with the song) or TRIG (restarts at the pattern's first step).
Step buttons	The LFO's 16 steps (1/16 notes, one bar). Tap: that step rests. Hold a step and turn knob 2 (its own WAVE) or knob 4 (its own DEPTH).

The drum sequencer

The steps live on the 16 step buttons, the screen shows what the knobs do. Each drum (lane) has its own length, up to 64 steps, and its own speed.

On every sequencer the step buttons inside the pattern light dim white, the steps with something on them red, and steps past the pattern's end are off.

Triplets: Menu, SETTINGS, **TRIPLETS** (below TIME SIG, saved with the project) turns every 4th step off: steps 4, 8, 12 and 16 go dark, do nothing when pressed and show as a dash, and the other steps play 3 in the time of 4. So a 1/16 lane plays 1/8 triplets, 1/8 plays 1/4 triplets and 1/32 plays 1/16 triplets. It works on every instrument's sequencer (drums and synths) at once; a pattern keeps its length in bars, so everything stays lined up. Steps already on the dark buttons are kept, silent, and come back when it's off. Turned on or off while playing, each pattern changes when it next comes round. The lane's RATE choices are straight ones (1/1 to 1/32); a lane from an older song on 1/8T or 1/16T keeps it until you turn its RATE. The arp keeps its own triplet rates.



The drum's 16 steps (small, at the top) and the lane's settings.

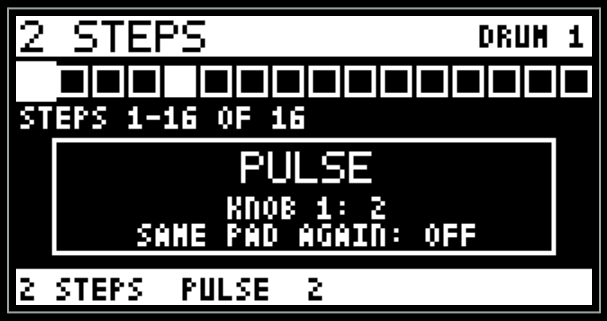


Shift + steps 1 and 5 tapped: they blink, and the pads are their settings.

Pads	Left 4 x 4: pick the drum (its pad lights brighter) and hear it. Shift + pad: the pattern.
Step buttons	Tap: the step on / off. While playing, the playhead moves along them.
Shift + step buttons	Select steps to set (below).
Left / Right arrows	Steps 17-32, 33-48, 49-64 (for lanes longer than 16).
Knob 1	LENGTH: the lane's number of steps (1-64).
Knob 2	RATE: the lane's speed. Ten rates, slowest to fastest, so turning right always speeds up. It only changes the speed: the lane keeps its steps (double time = a faster rate, same length).
Knob 3	EUCLID: spread a number of hits evenly over the lane (OFF to switch it off).
Knob 4	SHIFT: turn the lane's pattern around by steps.
+ / -	The pads' octave (the chromatic drum pads, a synth's notes). Patterns: Shift + a pad; while playing, the next one waits its turn (shown as PAT 1>2).
Undo	Undo the last pattern edit.

Step settings (OP-XY style)

Hold Shift and tap one or more steps: they blink. Let go of Shift. Now the pads are the steps' settings, bottom left first. Tap a pad: that setting is on and **knob 1** sets it. Tap the same pad again: it's off (back to normal). Lit pads: settings the step has; the picked one blinks. **Tap any step to finish.**



PULSE picked on two steps: knob 1 sets how many times they repeat.

Pad 1 VELOCITY	How hard (1-127, turned all the way down: RND, random).
Pad 2 CHANCE	How often it plays: 100% down to 0%, or 1:2, 2:3... (the 1st of every 2 times round, and so on).
Pad 3 MULTIPLY	Hits inside the step: x1 to x8, or RND.
Pad 4 PULSE	Play the step again 1-9 times (or RND) before moving on.
Pad 5 HOLD	Wait 1-9 steps (or RND) after it, silent.
Pad 6 JUMP	Then go to step 1, 5, 9 or 13, skip one (+1), back one (-1), either (+/-), or RND. Once each time round the lane.
Pad 7 RANDOM	A random pitch each time: 2-6 notes over 1 or 3 octaves.
Pad 8 RAMP UP	The pitch goes up each time round: 2-6 notes over 1 or 3 octaves.
Pad 9 RAMP DOWN	The same, going down. (One of RANDOM / RAMP UP / RAMP DOWN at a time.)
Pads 10-32	The drum's own sound settings (TUNE, DECAY...): a parameter lock for these steps.

Pitch moves use the drum's TUNE (or PITCH) setting, so how far a semitone goes depends on the drum machine. BEND, PORTAMENTO and TONALITY are for the synth sequencer, still to come.

Song mode (left button 2)

A list of rows, OP-XY style: each row picks a pattern for every instrument and says how many times it plays. With song mode on, Play starts at row 1 and goes through the rows, then round again.



Row 2: the LXR plays pattern 3, twice.

Step buttons	The rows. Press one past the end: a new row (a copy of the last). Lit: the rows; the playing one blinks.
Delete + step button	Take that row out.
Knobs 1-7	The row's pattern for instruments 1-7 (all the way down: -, leave it as it is).
Knob 8	How many times the row plays (1-16).
+ / -	+ switches song mode on, - off. **Shift + left button 2** does the same from any page (the tape shows SONG in its top line while it's on). Off: the picked pattern plays, as usual.

The synth sequencer

A synth's sequencer works on chords. The 16 step buttons are the steps (Left / Right for more).

UNIFIED or PER NOTE?

Knob 3 chooses how the pattern is built.

UNIFIED	One sequence of chords. Every step holds a chord, and the whole pattern shares one LENGTH and one RATE. Step settings (pulse, hold, jump...) apply to the step as a whole. Easiest: it works like a normal step sequencer, and a chord is just several pads on one step.
PER NOTE	Every pitch gets its own row. Tap a pad to pick a note (it turns white): the 16 steps now show only that note. Each note has its **own LENGTH (knob 1) and its own RATE (knob 2)**, and its own pulse / hold / jump / chance. Pads of notes that already have steps light **orange**; a step you are holding lights red.

Why use PER NOTE

Polyrhythm	Give a low C a length of 3 and a high G a length of 4: they drift against each other and only line up every 12 steps, so a simple two-note pattern keeps changing.

Drone under a melody	One note with a long length and a slow rate (a held bass or pedal tone) while a melody note runs 1/16 on top of it.
Arpeggio that evolves	Lay out an arpeggio one note per row, each with a different length (5, 7, 8, 11): the pattern takes a long time to repeat.
Different speeds	Bass at 1/8 while the lead is at 1/16 or in triplets, in one instrument.
Per-note feel	Chance 50% on a high note only, a jump or hold on one pitch only, so a pattern breathes without touching the rest.
Use UNIFIED when	you want chords, a hook that is the same length all the way through, or the quickest way to write a loop.
Step buttons	Tap: the notes on / off. Hold a step: the pads light its notes; tap pads to add or remove notes. Hold a step and tap a later step: that is where the notes end (also across pages).
Knobs (no step held)	1 length, 2 rate, 3 type (UNIFIED: one sequence; PER NOTE: tap a pad to see only its steps), 4 the lit note's own length, 5 key, 6 scale.
Shift + steps	Select steps: the pads are their settings. LENGTH, VELOCITY, CHANCE, MULTIPLY, **NUDGE** (a step early or late, -50 to +50 %), PULSE, HOLD, JUMP (PER NOTE type only), RANDOM, RAMP UP, RAMP DOWN (pitch), then the synth's own settings as parameter locks. Knob 1 sets the picked one.
Record	On a drum or synth sequencer page: the pads you play go into the pattern while it plays (a synth note lasts as long as you hold the pad; chromatic drum pads keep their pitch). Press again to stop. It doesn't touch the tape. Nothing is recorded into the pattern unless Record is on; it turns itself off at Stop and when you leave the page.
Step settings colours	Pads of tapped steps: yellow for the steps you picked, red for settings you changed, dim for the rest.
Stop	Every sounding note is let go at Stop (Dexed and other synths too).
Drums, by hand	Hold a step button and press a right-half pad: the step turns on with that pitch.

Pads: key and scale (synths)

On a synth's settings pages hold **Shift**: the icons light under the step buttons. **Shift + step button 2** (the hexagon) opens the PADS page (or press Right past the ARP page). Press the icon again, or **Back**, to return to the settings pages: the PADS page. Knob 1 KEY, knob 2 SCALE (12 scales, or CHROMATIC), knob 3 OCTAVE. The pads then play only notes in that key and scale, and the pads on the key's root note light white. It is the same key and scale as the synth sequencer's knobs 5 and 6. Knob 4 VELOCITY: TOUCH (the pads play and record how hard you hit them) or a fixed velocity (turn up from TOUCH: 100, then in fives). Knob 5 CURVE: SOFT (easier to play loud), NORMAL or HARD (needs a harder hit). Pattern recording now stores the velocity you played.

A drum machine has a PADS page too (Shift + step button 2 on its sound pages, or Right past INSERT 2). It has no key or scale: knob 1 OCTAVE (the right-hand pads, which play the picked drum a semitone a pad), knob 2 VELOCITY and knob 3 CURVE, which work as on a synth for the drum pads too.

Arpeggiator (synths)

A synth's last sound page is ARP (Right past INSERT 2; Right again: ARP 2), or hold Shift and press step button 3 (the branching-nodes icon) on its sound pages (the icon is bright when the arp is on). The arp turns the notes you hold on the pads, and the chords in the sequencer, into a run of single notes. What you record from the pads is the notes you played, not the arp's. A rest in the rhythm does not use up a note: the run carries on at the next one.

Knob 1 ON	Arp on / off.
Knob 2 MODE	UP, DOWN, UP-DOWN, DOWN-UP, RANDOM, AS PLAYED, CHORD (every step plays all the notes).
Knob 3 OCT	1-4 octaves.
Knob 4 RATE	The ten rates, slowest to fastest. A sequenced chord arpeggiates for as long as it lasts, so give it a longer length, or a faster rate, to hear more than one note.
Knob 5 GATE	How long each note lasts, 10-200 % of a step (over 100 they overlap).
Knob 6 HOLD	The notes keep going after you let go; new notes replace them.
Knob 7 STYLE	Five rhythm patterns laid over your rhythm: GALLOP, OFFBEAT, TRESILLO, SYNCOPATED, STUTTER (OFF: just your rhythm). A rest in either is a rest; an accent in either is an accent.
ARP 2 (Right)	Knob 1 GLIDE: portamento between the notes (the synth has to answer CC 65 / CC 5). Knob 2 BEND: each note starts bent up (+) or down (-) and slides to its pitch (pitch bend).
Step buttons	The 16-step rhythm: tap a step to go note (white), accent (red, louder), rest (off). It follows the song's clock while it plays.

FX

The reverb and delay sends and the insert effects are on each instrument *before* the tape, so they are recorded with the sound. The tape room has no effects.

Left button 3	Reverb page, again: delay, again: SONG INSERT 1, again: SONG INSERT 2, again: off.
SONG INSERT 1 / 2	One effect for the whole song. The tape records each instrument on its own track, so every loaded instrument gets its own copy of it (after its own INSERT 1 and 2), all following the settings on this page, and it is recorded with each instrument, as the reverb and delay are. Push the wheel to choose the effect (the same picture picker); knobs 1-8 are its settings. A copy each means a compressor or limiter works on each instrument on its own, not on the mix as a whole; character effects (tape, saturation, filters, lo-fi) work as you'd expect. Each copy uses the effect's CPU, so heavy effects on many instruments add up. Tape Echo 2, Dissolver, Dragonfly Hall and Cloudseed aren't offered here (with a copy on every instrument they were too heavy in the load test); they are still there as an instrument's own inserts. The Move's input jack doesn't get them. Saved with the project.
Knobs 1-3	The effect: reverb size, tone, level / delay time, feedback, level.
Knob 4	How much of the picked instrument goes to this effect.
INSERT 1 / 2	The last two sound pages of an instrument (after LFO 2; wheel or arrows). Each instrument has two insert effects in a row, picked from 36 (filter, EQ, tape, reverbs, granular...). Push the wheel to open the picture picker: turn to browse, push to choose, Back to cancel. Knobs 1-8 are the effect's first eight settings; every effect has its own picture. They are on the instrument *before* the tape, so what you record from that instrument has the effects in it; nothing is added to the tape afterwards. A Ducker ducks its instrument whenever drum 1 of another instrument is hit.

Ableton Link

Menu, SETTINGS, MIDI SYNC, LINK. Console then shares its tempo (while stopped; a playing tape keeps its tempo) and its Play / Stop with Live and phone apps on the same Wi-Fi. Starting waits for the next bar.

Menus and export

Menu	The project menu: songs (new, open, save as), tempo, time signature, export format, settings. Jog wheel: pick, push: choose, Back: close.
Shift in the project menu	NEW PROJECT becomes DELETE PROJECT and SAVE PROJECT becomes RENAME PROJECT. Pick the project, then confirm ARE YOU SURE? to delete (you go back to the main menu). Shift + wheel still moves up and down.
Settings	Push the wheel on a setting to edit it (the value shows in a white box), turn to change, push again to let go.
Shift + Menu	Export: a stereo mix and one file per track, in /data/UserData/console/data/exports/(song name and time)/.

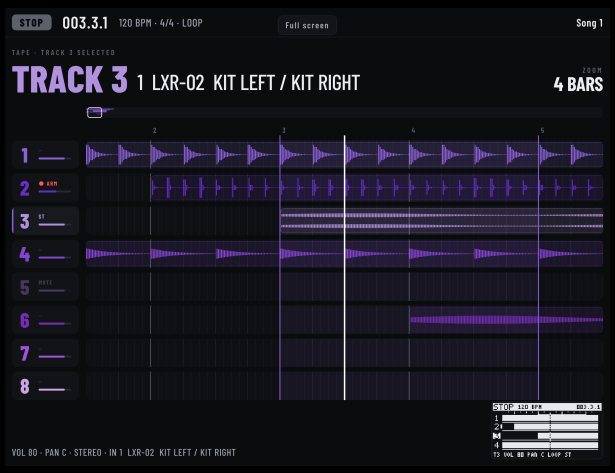
To copy the exports to the Mac's desktop:

```
scp -r "ableton@move.local:/data/UserData/console/data/exports" ~/Desktop/move-exports
```

External screen (a phone or tablet)

The Move can show what it is doing on a bigger screen: the tape, the sequencer, the instrument's sound pages and the arpeggiator, redrawn large and updating live. Nothing to install: it is a web page the Move serves.

Open it	Menu, SETTINGS, **EXTERNAL SCREEN**, push. The Move shows a QR code: scan it with the phone's camera. Any button closes the code.
Same network	The phone and the Move must be on the same Wi-Fi. With the phone's own hotspot, join the Move to the hotspot and scan the code (its address changes, so the QR code is the way in). On a normal network the address `http://move.local:8080` also works.
Browser	Samsung Internet works. Chrome may refuse because it insists on https:// for new addresses; open the page in another browser then.
Tape	Eight lanes with their waveforms, a bar and beat grid (sixteenths when zoomed right in) so you can see where a splice lands, the loop, the playhead and the track's volume. ARM shows only on tracks that really record (armed with Shift + a step button).
Instrument pages	The sequencer (drum steps or a synth's piano roll) and the sound page with its 8 settings as vertical bars. Its tabs go on past the instrument's own pages as the Move does: LFO 1, LFO 2, INSERT 1 and INSERT 2 with the same setting cards (an INSERT page also shows the effect's picture and name), then PADS (and on a synth ARP), each as a panel with all its options. On the instruments list the title says INST and the slot number instead of a track.
Arp and pads	On the ARP or PADS page: a translucent panel over the sound page with every arp setting and all its options. The picked option is white, the rest dim; GATE, GLIDE, BEND and VELOCITY show their value, and the arp's 16 rhythm steps are along the bottom.
Reverb and delay	Left button 3's REVERB and DELAY pages show as the same kind of panel: SIZE, TONE, LEVEL (reverb) or TIME, FEEDBACK, LEVEL (delay), and knob 4, the picked instrument's send.
Menus and lists	Whatever menu or list the Move has open shows as a panel too: the project menu, SETTINGS, open / delete / rename project, naming, the instrument menu (presets, copy / paste / clear pattern), the questions it asks, the sample browser, choosing an effect or an instrument (with its picture), the instruments list and song mode. The picked row is lit; long lists scroll.
Colours	Each session picks one colour family at random and uses its shades.



The tape on a tablet, with the bar and beat grid.



The arp panel over a sound page.



MENU, SETTINGS, EXTERNAL SCREEN: scan the code (the address shown is an example).

Not on the Move yet

The LFOs' parameter locks beyond depth and wave; pictures for the instruments that still show their name; the tape's bar/beat grid when zoomed in a long way. Songs are saved in /data/UserData/console/data.